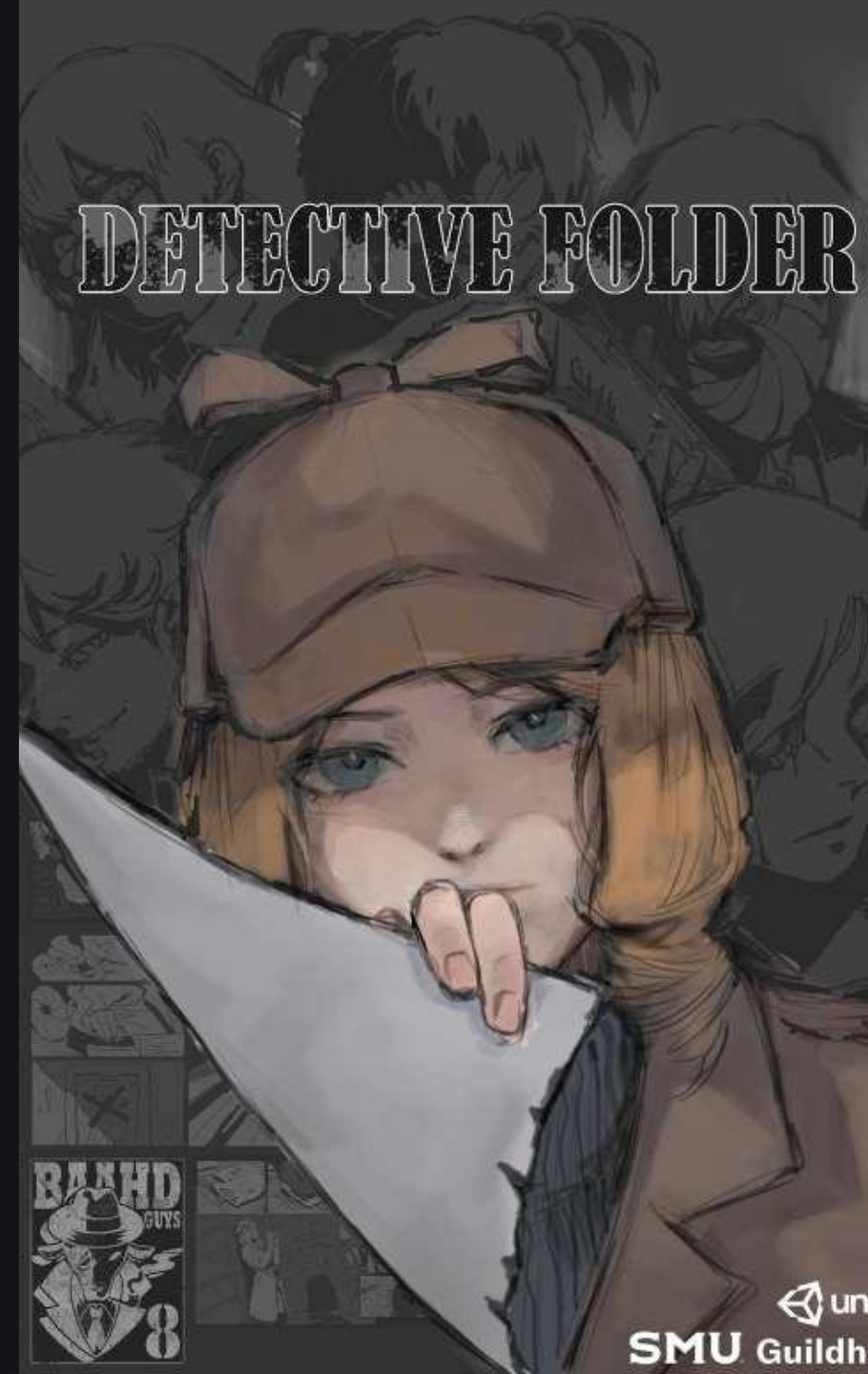


SMU GUILDHALL • PRODUCTION PLAN

DETECTIVE FOLDER

From Studio Demo to Live-Service Mobile Game

Present by Young Gou



THE CASE FILE WE START FROM

The demo we already built

CORE LOOP

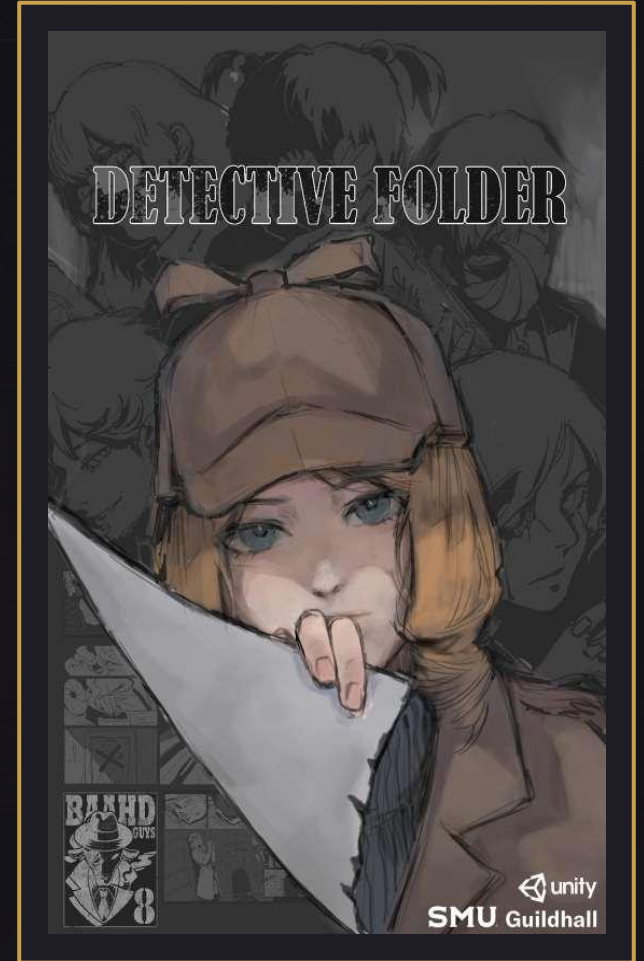
Walk → Jump → Fold

SECONDARY LOOP

Explore → Collect → Avoid

THE GOAL

Catch the Baahd Guys



Keep the loop. Build a live game around it.



PROTECT

The fold loop, the 4 levels, the noir story.



REBUILD

The same systems, remade for touch & content.



ADD

Progression, LiveOps, monetization, backend, QA.

The conversion at a glance

CARRIED OVER • DF 1-6

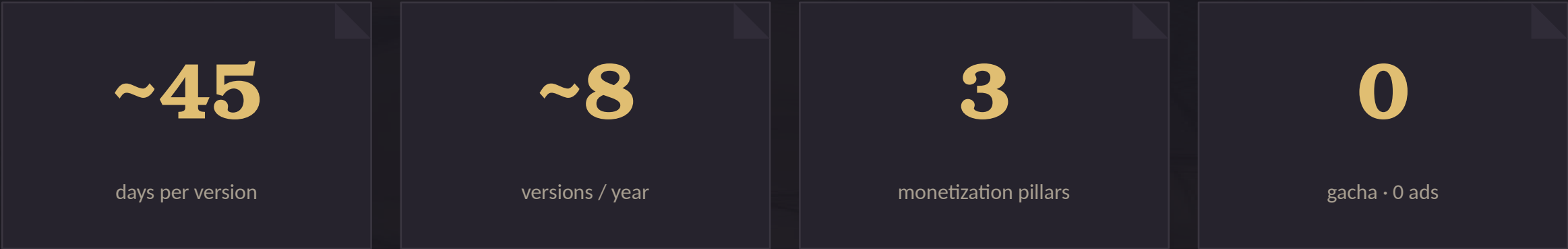
DF 1	Core gameplay
DF 2	Level system
DF 3	Character system
DF 4	Environment & objects
DF 5	Comic narrative
DF 6	UI & menu system

NEW LIVE-SERVICE SYSTEMS • DF 7-11

DF 7	Player progression
DF 8	LiveOps & events
DF 9	Monetization
DF 10	Online & backend
DF 11	QA & compatibility

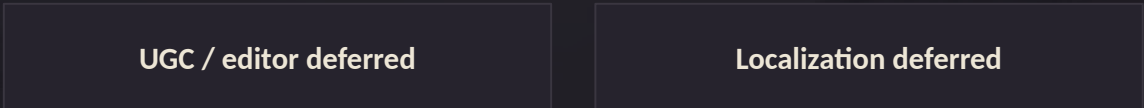
LOCKED PRODUCT DEFINITION

What we are actually shipping



Narrative-driven detective live-service game. Monetization: battle pass + monthly card + skin shop.

EXPLICITLY OUT OF SCOPE



Reworking the core for mobile

1 Touch controls

2 Level toolset

3 Cosmetic skins

4 Extensible objects

5 Store screens

6 English pipeline

Five new systems make it live

DF 7	Player progression	Retention spine
DF 8	LiveOps & events	Events • economy • A/B
DF 9	Monetization	Battle pass • card • skins
DF 10	Online & backend	Accounts • save • analytics
DF 11	QA & compatibility	Devices • cert • regression

The roadmap



From building the game to running it

BUILD • MS0-MS4

Make the game and ship it

- 1 Prototype proves the fold loop on mobile
- 2 Levels 1-4 content-complete; store UI
- 3 Cert, IAP, Gold Master — launch

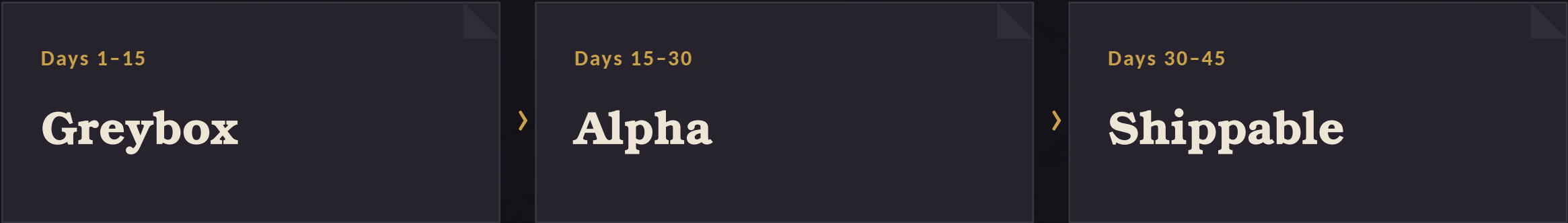
LIVE • MS5-MS6

Archive, then run the engine

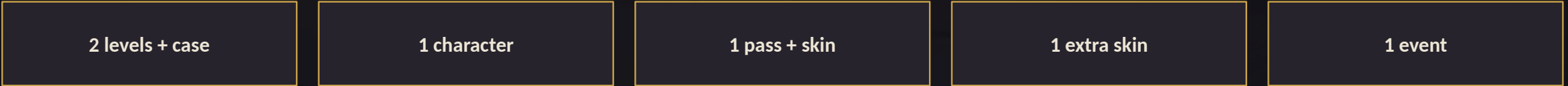
- ◆ Archive source, tools & pipelines (MS5)
- ◆ Ship a new version every 45 days (MS6)
- ◆ Data tunes the next cycle — full speed through 2028

THE HEART OF A LIVE GAME

The 45-day content engine

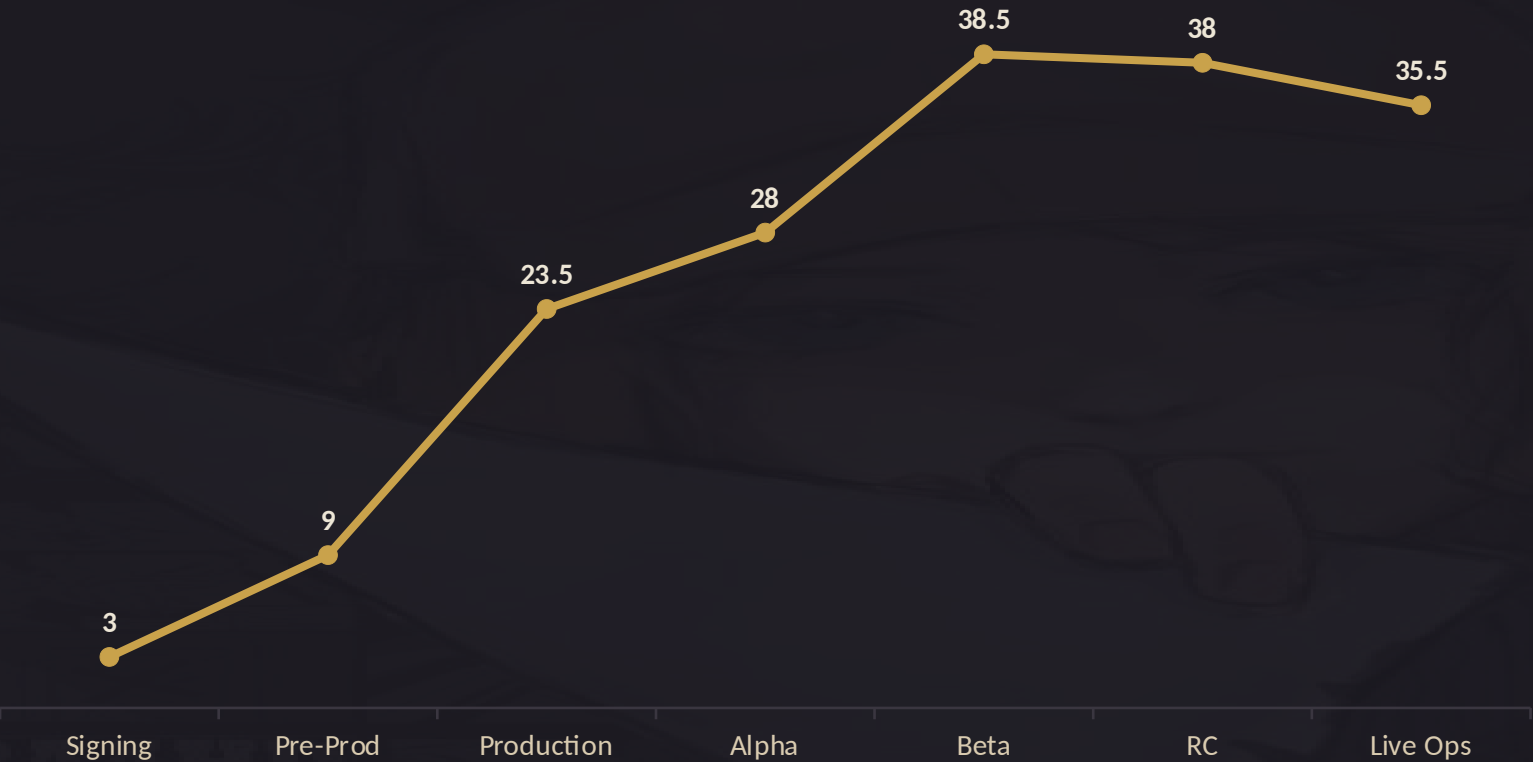


EVERY CYCLE SHIPS



~8 level-equivalents are built before launch, so the cadence starts full-speed on day one.

Ramp to a runway, then sustain



38.5
peak (Beta)

~20-24
steady live-ops

What the plan costs

\$9.63M

TOTAL LABOR COST

951.5

TOTAL MAN-MONTHS

43

ROLES • 8 TEAMS

38 in-house across 8 feature teams + 5 outsourced vendors. Salaries benchmarked to the 2025 GDC Salary Report.

What we chose, and what we watch

Protect the core loop

Deliberate

Cosmetic-only revenue

Positioning

Content pace

Risk → mitigated

Deferred scope

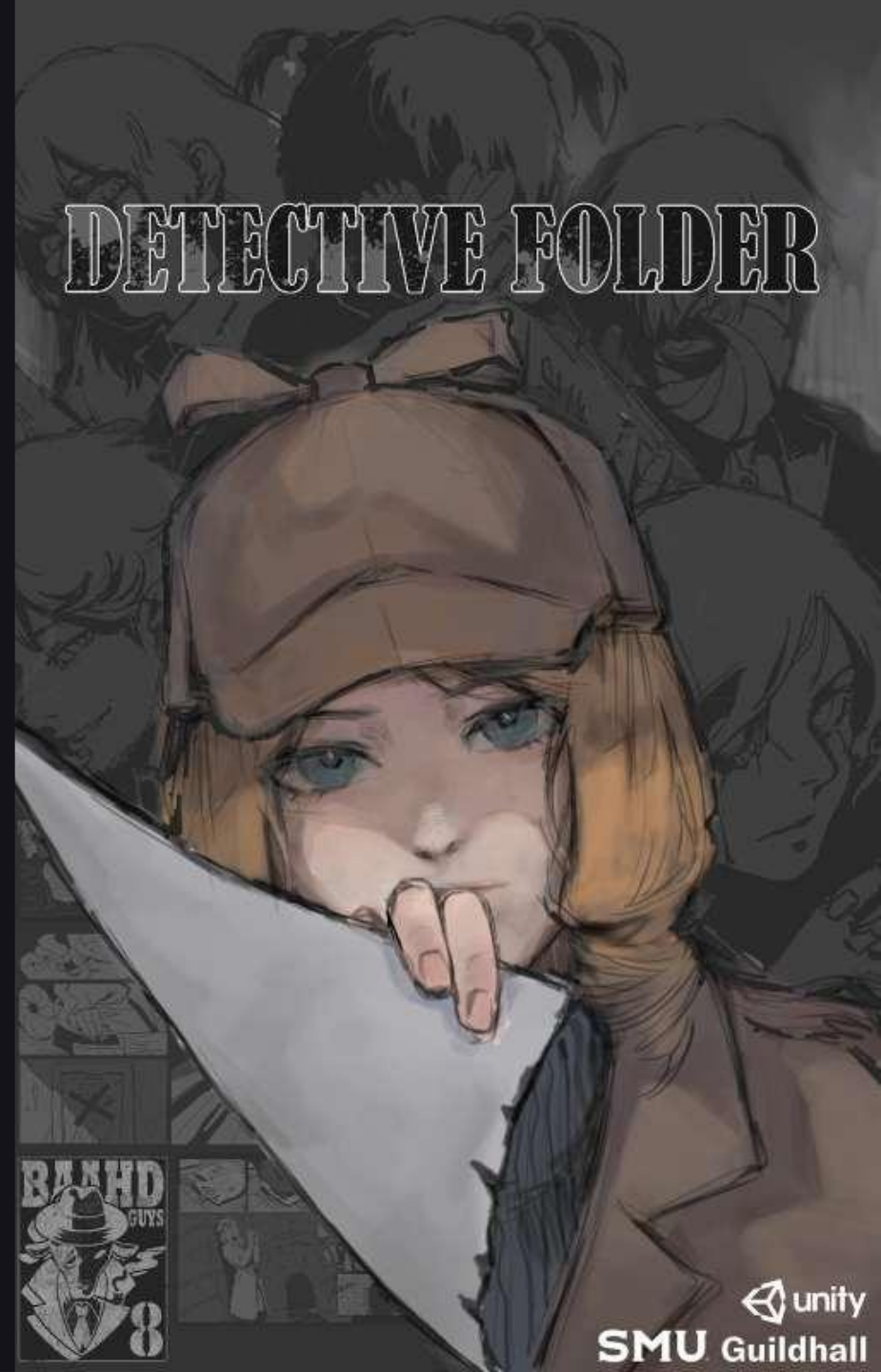
Watch

THE PATH FORWARD

From a folded page to a living game

- ◆ Keep the fold loop; rebuild for mobile.
- ◆ Launch Dec 2027 on a pre-built runway.
- ◆ Run a 45-day engine — ~8 versions a year.

Detective Folder · SMU Guildhall



Thanks for Listening!

Any Questions?

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